

CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

CLASS 12TH BIHAR BOARD – ENGLISH (RAINBOW PART 2)

POETRY CHAPTER 5: AN EPITAPH (BY WALTER DE LA MARE)

 CHAPTER SUMMARY (IN 50 WORDS)

"An Epitaph" is a touching and melancholic poem composed by Walter de la Mare. The poet mourns the death of an exceptionally beautiful lady of the West Country. He reflects that physical beauty is fleeting and vanishes with time, but noble character and memories are everlasting.

 12 IMPORTANT SHORT SUBJECTIVE QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Q1. What is an "Epitaph"? What does the inscription signify?

Ans: An epitaph is an inscription written on a tombstone or grave in memory of a deceased person. It signifies a tribute, keeping the memory of the dead alive.

Q2. Where does the beautiful lady lie, according to the poet?

Ans: The beautiful lady lies inside a cold, silent grave or tomb situated in the West Country, resting eternally.

Q3. How does the poet describe the lady's nature or habits?

Ans: The poet describes her as a lady of "light of step and heart," meaning she was carefree, liked to wander around, and had an unpredictable nature.

Q4. What does the poet think about human physical beauty?

Ans: The poet thinks that physical beauty is temporary and fleeting. It gradually fades, passes away, and vanishes over time, no matter how rare it is.

Q5. What is the poet's main grief or worry in the poem?

Ans: His main grief is that when he crumbles (dies), there will be absolutely no one left in the world to remember this beautiful lady of the West Country.

Q6. Why does the poet consider the lady to be the most beautiful woman?

Ans: He considers her the most beautiful woman because he loved her deeply, and her physical appearance surpassed everyone else in the entire West Country.

Q7. What does the phrase "vanishes, beauty passes" mean?



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Ans: It means that external physical charm is mortal. Age, time, and death eventually destroy all physical beauty, making it transient.

Q8. What country or region did the lady belong to?

Ans: The lady belonged to the "West Country," which refers to the western region of England or the United Kingdom.

Q9. What does the poet mean by the word "crumble"?

Ans: In the context of the poem, the word "crumble" metaphorically means to die, break down, and turn into dust after death.

Q10. Who was Walter de la Mare, and what kind of themes did he write about?

Ans: Walter de la Mare was a famous English poet and novelist known for his interest in the supernatural, psychological themes, and children's literature.

Q11. Why does the poem have a melancholic or sad tone?

Ans: It has a sad tone because it deals with the absolute reality of death, the loss of a loved one, and the loneliness that follows when a memory fades.

Q12. What is the central message of "An Epitaph"?

Ans: The central message is that moral virtues and spiritual love are superior to physical beauty because beauty dies, but true feelings outlive the grave.

35 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS (QUESTION & OPTIONS IN SINGLE LINE)

- 'An Epitaph' is a beautifully composed short poem by: (A) John Keats (B) Walter de la Mare (C) W.H. Auden (D) Rupert Brooke
- Walter de la Mare was a famous British poet, essayist, and: (A) Scientist (B) Novelist / Short story writer (C) Politician (D) Doctor
- Walter de la Mare was born in the year 1873 and passed away in: (A) 1948 (B) 1956 (C) 1968 (D) 1974
- Queen Elizabeth II honored Walter de la Mare with the Order of Merit in: (A) 1947 (B) 1952 (C) 1953 (D) 1960
- Walter de la Mare is deeply famous for making adults aware of the world of: (A) machinery (B) children and the supernatural (C) world wars (D) business
- An epitaph is a short text or poem inscribed on a: (A) school wall (B) tombstone / grave (C) gold coin (D) textbook
- "Here lies a most beautiful _____": (A) child (B) lady (C) bird (D) flower
- The lady mentioned in the text belonged to the beautiful: (A) East Country (B) West Country (C) North Country (D) South Country



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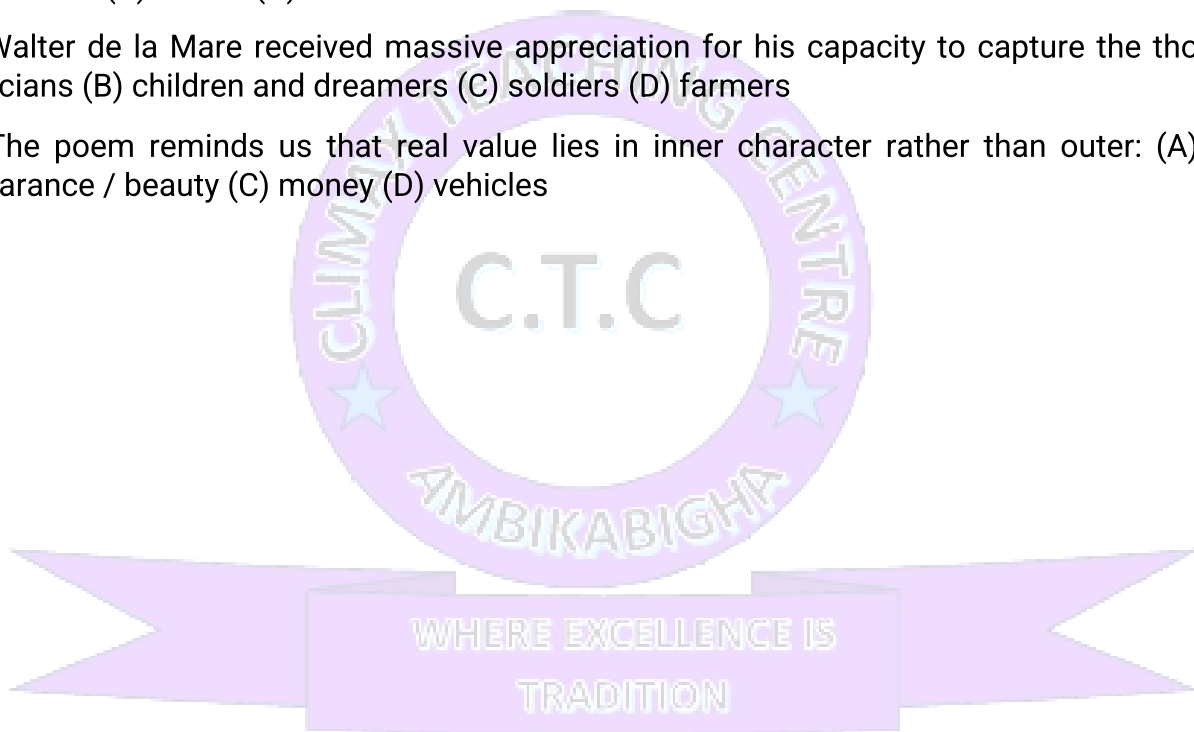
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9. "Light of _____ and heart was she;": (A) mind (B) step (C) eyes (D) voice
10. The phrase "light of step and heart" indicates that the lady was: (A) lazy (B) habituated to wandering / carefree (C) angry (D) highly religious
11. "I think she was the most beautiful lady / That ever was in the _____ .": (A) world (B) West Country (C) city (D) palace
12. "But beauty _____ , beauty passes,": (A) stays (B) vanishes / fades (C) grows (D) shines
13. The poet emphasizes that no matter how _____ beauty is, it eventually ends.: (A) cheap (B) rare (C) common (D) heavy
14. "And when I _____ , who will remember...": (A) sing (B) crumble / die (C) laugh (D) run
15. In this poem, the word 'crumble' directly stands for: (A) to dance (B) to die / turn to dust (C) to build (D) to sleep
16. The poet feels sad because after his death, the lady will be completely: (A) rewarded (B) forgotten (C) searched (D) praised
17. The tone of the poem 'An Epitaph' is intensely: (A) joyful (B) melancholic / sad (C) humorous (D) aggressive
18. The poem deals with the transitoriness or short life of human: (A) money (B) physical beauty (C) houses (D) tools
19. Famous poetry collections of Walter de la Mare include 'Songs for Children' and: (A) Leaves of Grass (B) Peacock Pie (C) Songs and Sonnets (D) Lyrical Ballads
20. The poet used to have deep feelings of _____ for the deceased lady.: (A) hatred (B) love and affection (C) jealousy (D) anger
21. The inscription on the grave is a medium to preserve the lady's: (A) wealth (B) memory (C) clothes (D) signature
22. The lady is currently lying down in a state of: (A) deep sleep / death (B) action (C) running (D) anger
23. External physical charm, according to the poem, is completely: (A) immortal (B) mortal / temporary (C) structural (D) useless
24. Walter de la Mare was born in the village of Charlton in: (A) London / Kent (B) New York (C) Dublin (D) Paris
25. The lady's habit of changing her mind easily shows her: (A) wisdom (B) fickle-minded nature (C) absolute honesty (D) wealth
26. "An Epitaph" is categorized structurally as a short: (A) epic (B) lyric / elegy (C) drama (D) essay
27. The beauty of the lady was supreme but lacked: (A) color (B) permanence (C) shape (D) cost
28. The poet acts as a solitary mourner next to the lady's: (A) garden (B) grave (C) palace (D) house
29. Who will remember the lady of the West Country when the poet dies?: (A) Everyone (B) No one (C) Her family (D) The King



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30. The poem presents a contrast between fleeting charm and permanent: (A) cash (B) spiritual values / memories (C) weapons (D) physical health
31. The poem contains exactly _____ lines, making it a very short and punchy piece.: (A) six (B) eight (C) ten (D) fourteen
32. The word 'vanishes' in the poem means to: (A) appear (B) disappear completely (C) shine bright (D) clean up
33. The line "Light of step and heart was she" is a poetic way of showing her: (A) weight (B) behavior / movements (C) illness (D) education
34. Walter de la Mare received massive appreciation for his capacity to capture the thoughts of: (A) politicians (B) children and dreamers (C) soldiers (D) farmers
35. The poem reminds us that real value lies in inner character rather than outer: (A) clothing (B) appearance / beauty (C) money (D) vehicles



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